THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT

Marking & Feedback Policy

THE TRIPARTITE CURRICULUM ARCHITECTURE

1. MASTER TEXTBOOKS
2. PUPIL WORKBOOKS
3. RETRIEVAL COMPANIONS

Approved for Academic Year 2026–2027

Department Lead • The History Revision Hub Platform Standards

Part 1: Departmental Rationale & Tripartite Architecture

The History Department prioritises meaningful, manageable, and motivating feedback, focusing on high-impact live intervention, whole-class modelling, and structured pupil self-regulation over performative red-pen marking. Our feedback system is integrated into a unified **Tripartite Curriculum Model**:

PILLAR 1: MASTER TEXTBOOKS

Pure narrative reading anthologies (zero source boxes, zero rubrics) providing immersive, high-challenge prose during whole-class reading before writing begins.

PILLAR 2: PUPIL WORKBOOKS

16–20 page saddle-stitch workbooks. Verso: 5-Stage Chronological Inquiry Spine; Recto: Disciplinary writing on calibrated ~7.8mm–8.1mm ruled handwriting lines.

PILLAR 3: RETRIEVAL COMPANIONS

8-page (KS3) and 16–28 page (GCSE) companions featuring Domino causal flowcharts, 2-line dual retrieval, and self-scoring Marking Banks.

Centring Pupil Voice & Live Metacognition

Feedback is an active dialogue, not a retrospective teacher chore. Live marking during circulating coaching prompts pupils to vocalise historical reasoning, correct misconceptions in real time with green pen, and complete end-of-unit reflection grids in their workbooks to document progress and set immediate targets.

Zero Knowledge Giveaways in Scaffolds

Sentence stems and connectives in pupil workbooks provide purely structural, disciplinary scaffolding—never factual answers. Key Terms banks supply technical vocabulary (e.g. *Diktat, Article 231, £6.6bn reparations*), but connectives remain strictly content-free (e.g. *In particular, a decisive factor was...*), forcing pupils to retrieve historical knowledge from memory rather than transcribing hints.

Frequency of Marking

Key Stage 3

Routine classwork is reviewed via live circulating coaching and self-marking with the Knowledge Retrieval Companion's Marking Bank. Teachers assess one substantial disciplinary extended writing task (Explain Why 12m, Narrative Account 8m, or Interpretations 8m) per half term using the 5 Pathway Levels.

Key Stage 4 (GCSE)

Regular low-stakes rehearsals using Pearson Edexcel past questions. Teachers provide live exemplar modelling and mark formal timed assessments across Paper 1 (Medicine & Western Front), Paper 2 (Elizabeth & Middle East), and Paper 3 (Weimar & USA) against Pearson 9–1 mark criteria and CAT4 benchmarks.

Part 2: Standards, Grading & Feedback Types

Types of Marking & Feedback

1. Live In-The-Moment Coaching

Teacher circulates while pupils write on ruled lines, checking historical precision and intervening immediately with verbal coaching and green-pen margin codes.

2. Retrieval Companion Self-Scoring

Pupils complete low-stakes starters and self-mark immediately using the verified Marking Bank at the back of the companion, cementing factual recall and schema retention.

3. Disciplinary Writing Assessment

End-of-enquiry written pieces are assessed against national progression criteria (KS3) or Pearson Edexcel 9–1 criteria (GCSE), recorded on the workbook back cover ledger.

4. Spaced App Quizzing & QR Retrieval

Dual-QR codes on workbook back covers link pupils directly to interactive 20-question digital quizzes on the History Revision Hub, automating diagnostics and homework retrieval.

Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (SPaG)

Consistent whole-school marking symbols applied across all humanities written work:

Symbol	Meaning	Symbol	Meaning
Sp	Incorrect spelling (write 3x in margin)	^	Word omitted
P	Punctuation error (. , ! ?)	?	Meaning unclear / historical confusion
G	Grammar error / sentence structure	!	Factual / chronological inaccuracy
C	Capital letter required (proper noun/date)	✓	Valid historical evidence / explanation
//	New paragraph required	✓✓	Exceptional analytical insight / causal link

Assessment & Grading Framework

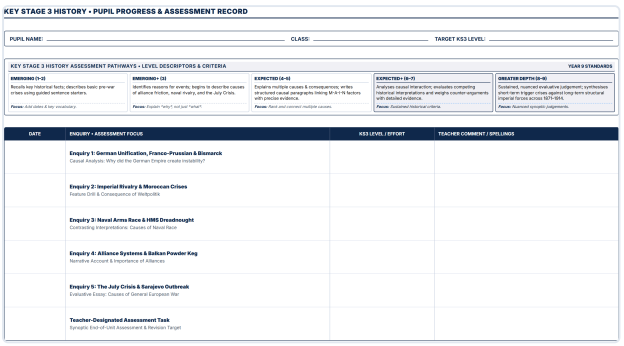
Progress tracking is maintained using the ledger on the inside front/back cover of workbooks, aligned to national standards and indicative GCSE outcomes:

Pathway Level	Score Band	Indicative GCSE	Disciplinary Writing Standard
GD (Greater Depth)	80% – 100%	Grades 8 – 9	Sustained causal argument, conceptual hierarchy, nuanced evaluation.
Exp + (Expected +)	60% – 79%	Grades 6 – 7	Consistent analytical structure, detailed evidence deployment, clear links.
Exp (Expected)	40% – 59%	Grades 4 – 5	Accurate historical knowledge, structured explanation, sound PEEL points.
EM + (Emerging +)	30% – 39%	Grade 3	Descriptive accounts, basic causal awareness, emerging terminology.
EM (Emerging)	10% – 29%	Grades 1 – 2	Fragmentary recall, simple narrative statements requiring teacher guidance.

Part 3: Exemplar Implementation & Visual Evidence (Key Stage 3)

VISUAL APPENDIX • KS3

Key Stage 3 workbooks embed our double-page spread architecture: Verso inquiry spine [1.1]–[5.5] with left-trigger keywords; Recto writing tasks on calibrated ~7.8mm–8.1mm handwriting pitch with zero knowledge giveaways in scaffolds.


KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY • PUPIL PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT RECORD

PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TARGET KS3 LEVEL: _____

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY ASSESSMENT PATHWAYS • LEVEL DESCRIPTORS & CRITERIA — YEAR 9 STANDARDS

EMERGING (1–2)	EMERGING+ (3)	EXPECTED (4–6)	EXPECTED+ (6–7)	GREATER DEPTH (8–9)
Recalls key historical facts; describes basic pre-war crises using guided sentence starters. *Focus: Add dates & key vocabulary.*	Identifies reasons for events; begins to describe causes of alliance friction, naval rivalry, and the July Crisis. *Focus: Explain "why?", not just "what".*	Explains multiple causes & consequences; writes structured causal paragraphs linking M-A-I-N factors with precise evidence. *Focus: Rank and connect multiple causes.*	Analyses causal interaction; evaluates competing historical interpretations and weighs counter-arguments with detailed evidence. *Focus: Sustained historical criteria.*	Sustained, nuanced evaluative judgement; synthesises short-term trigger crises against long-term structural imperial forces across 1871–1914. *Focus: Nuanced synoptic judgements.*

DATE	ENQUIRY • ASSESSMENT FOCUS	KS3 LEVEL / EFFORT	TEACHER COMMENT / SPELLINGS
	Enquiry 1: German Unification, Franco-Prussian & Bismarck — Causal Analysis: Why did the German Empire create instability?		
	Enquiry 2: Imperial Rivalry & Moroccan Crises — Fashoda Drill & Consequence of Weltpolitik		
	Enquiry 3: Naval Arms Race & HMS Dreadnought — Contrasting Interpretations: Causes of Naval Race		
	Enquiry 4: Alliance Systems & Balkan Powder Keg — Narrative Account & Importance of Alliances		
	Enquiry 5: The July Crisis & Sarajevo Outbreak — Evaluative Essay: Causes of General European War		
	Teacher-Designated Assessment Task — Synoptic End-of-Unit Assessment & Revision Target		

Figure 1: Progress & Assessment Ledger (KS3 Workbook). Lesson-by-lesson audit trail recording Effort (1–5), Pathway Standard (EM to GD), and formative teacher/pupil dialogue.

Dual-Pathway Centrefold Timeline

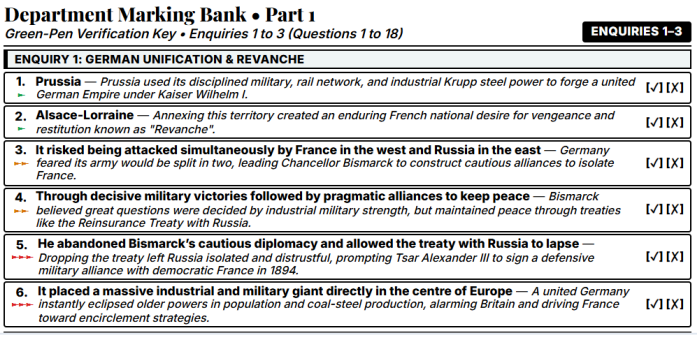
The centrefold (Pages 8–9 or 10–11) features our Panoramic Living Timeline with a binary dual-coding protocol:

- **Choice A (Visual Dual-Coding):** Pupils draw a symbolic icon representing the decisive causal mechanism.
- **Choice B (Concept Mind Map):** Pupils construct a 3-branch analytical web linking cause, event, and consequence.

Effort Scoring Rubric (1–5)

Score	Pupil Focus & Diligence
5 • Exemplary	Proactive curiosity; voluntary extension; exceptional pride.
4 • Good	Consistent engagement; thoughtful contributions; complete work.
3 • Satisfactory	Meets baseline; requires occasional prompting.
2 • Inconsistent	Incomplete written tasks; frequent off-task reminders.
1 • Concern	Persistent passivity; triggers departmental intervention.

Visual Evidence: Retrieval Companion Marking Bank & Green-Pen Self-Scoring


Department Marking Bank • Part 1

Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 1 to 3 (Questions 1 to 18)

ENQUIRIES 1–3

ENQUIRY 1: GERMAN UNIFICATION & REVANCHE

1. **Prussia** — *Prussia used its disciplined military, rail network, and industrial Krupp steel power to forge a united German Empire under Kaiser Wilhelm I.* [✓] [X]
2. **Alsace-Lorraine** — *Annexing this territory created an enduring French national desire for vengeance and restitution known as "Revanche".* [✓] [X]
3. **It risked being attacked simultaneously by France in the west and Russia in the east** — *Germany feared its army would be split in two, leading Chancellor Bismarck to construct cautious alliances to isolate France.* [✓] [X]
4. **Through decisive military victories followed by pragmatic alliances to keep peace** — *Bismarck believed great questions were decided by industrial military strength, but maintained peace through treaties like the Reinsurance Treaty with Russia.* [✓] [X]
5. **He abandoned Bismarck's cautious diplomacy and allowed the treaty with Russia to lapse** — *Dropping the treaty left Russia isolated and distrustful, prompting Tsar Alexander III to sign a defensive military alliance with democratic France in 1894.* [✓] [X]
6. **It placed a massive industrial and military giant directly in the centre of Europe** — *A united Germany instantly eclipsed older powers in population and coal-steel production, alarming Britain and driving France toward encirclement strategies.* [✓] [X]

Figure 2: Department Marking Bank & Green-Pen Verification Key (Retrieval Companion, pp. 7–8). Pupils complete low-stakes retrieval starters from memory, then immediately verify accuracy in green pen using the Marking Bank. Binary verification ticks [✓] and query tags [?] drive immediate metacognitive self-regulation before circulating teacher intervention.

Part 4: Exemplar Implementation & Visual Evidence (Key Stage 4)

VISUAL APPENDIX • KS4

At Key Stage 4, feedback is structured around Pearson Edexcel exam question tariffs, PEEL writing frames with content-free connectives, and targeted question intelligence:

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT — KEY TOPIC 5 ASSESSMENT RECORD • 6 CURRICULUM HOURS • 1914–1918

PUPIL NAME: _____ TARGET: _____ CURRENT GRADE: _____

ENQUIRY	ASSESSMENT COMPONENT FOCUS	PAGE	SCORE	TEACHER COMMENT & NEXT STEPS
KT5.1	**Q1:** Describe Two Features of Trenches / Arras [4m]	p. 7	/ 4	MARKING FEEDBACK • TARGETS:
	Q2(a): Source Utility Assessment (Trench Design) [8m]	p. 5–7	/ 8	
KT5.2	**Q1:** Describe Two Features of Trench Foot / Fever [4m]	p. 11	/ 4	MARKING FEEDBACK • TARGETS:
	Q2(b): 4-Prompt Follow-Up Matrix (Living Conditions) [4m]	p. 9–11	/ 4	

Figure 3: Key Topic Assessment & Progress Record (Edexcel Medicine & Western Front Workbook, Page 28). Lesson-by-lesson audit tracking Pearson Edexcel exam question tariffs (Q1 4m Features, Q2a 8m Utility, Q2b 4m Follow-Up), pupil scores, and targeted teacher next steps.

Specification-Specific Question Tariffs

- **Paper 1 (Western Front):** Feature questions exist *strictly* as two separate 2-mark questions: Q1(a) [2m] and Q1(b) [2m].
- **Paper 2 (Elizabethan):** Two distinct 2-mark feature questions: Q1(a) [2m] and Q1(b) [2m].
- **Paper 2 (Middle East):** Updated single 4-mark consequence format ('Explain one consequence of...').

Provenance Clues ('How Useful' Utility Prompts)

Scaffolding boxes guide students to evaluate **Author** (access, expertise), **Audience** (private diary vs mass propaganda), and **Motive** (substantive purpose) against verified historical context, eliminating generic speculation.

Longitudinal Exam Trend Intelligence & Automated Quizzing

QUESTION FOCUS	2018	2019	2020	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Section A: Western Front Historic Environment Enquiry 16m (Q1 Features: 4m • Q2a Utility: 8m • Q2b Follow-Up: 4m)	SECTION A 16m — Treatment of Battle Injuries Q1: 4m • Q2a: 8m • Q2b: 4m	SECTION A 16m — Stretcher Bearers Q1: 4m • Q2a: 8m • Q2b: 4m	SECTION A 16m — Gas Attacks Q1: 4m • Q2a: 8m • Q2b: 4m	SECTION A 16m — Trench Foot Q1: 4m • Q2a: 8m • Q2b: 4m	SECTION A 16m — New Techniques to Deal with Injuries Q1: 4m • Q2a: 8m • Q2b: 4m	SECTION A 16m — Medical Staff in Casualty Clearing Stations Q1: 4m • Q2a: 8m • Q2b: 4m	SECTION A 16m — Difficulties in Caring for the Wounded Q1: 4m • Q2a: 8m • Q2b: 4m	SECTION A 16m — Transporting Wounded Along Evacuation Chain Q1: 4m • Q2a: 8m • Q2b: 4m
Q3: Similarity / Difference 4m (Thematic c1250-present)	Q3 [4m] Medieval vs Industrial Hospital Care	Q3 [4m] Ideas About Causes of Illness: 18th/19th Century vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Medieval Physician vs NHS Doctor	Q3 [4m] Preventing Infectious Diseases: Renaissance vs Industrial	Q3 [4m] Prevention of Illness: Medieval vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Treatment of Infectious Diseases: Medieval vs Modern	Q3 [4m] Epidemics: Great Plague (1665) vs Cholera (1854)	Q3 [4m] Preventing Infectious Diseases: Renaissance vs Modern
Q4: Causation Explanation 12m (Thematic c1250-present)	Q4 [12m] Prevention of Illness c1700-present	Q4 [12m] Renaissance Medical Knowledge c1500-c1700	Q4 [12m] Science & Technology in Modern Medicine c1900-present	Q4 [12m] Attitudes Towards Surgery c1800-present	Q4 [12m] Access to Medical Care & Treatment in Modern Period	Q4 [12m] Why Little Change in Medieval Medicine c1250-c1500	Q4 [12m] Impact of Pasteur's Germ Theory c1861-present	Q4 [12m] Hospital Care & Treatment Improvements c1700-c1900
Q5: Judgement Essay (Choice A) 16m + 4m SPaG (Extended)	Q5 [16m] Understanding Cause of Disease c1250-c1700	Q5 [16m] Galen & Medieval Medical Care c1250-c1500	Q5 [16m] Florence Nightingale & Hospital Care c1700-c1900	Q5 [16m] Medieval Care & Treatment: Role of Physician c1250-c1500	Q5 [16m] Thomas Sydenham as Key Turning Point c1500-c1700	Q5 [16m] Progress in Medical Knowledge in Renaissance c1500-c1700	Q5 [16m] Four Humours & Medicine c1250-c1700	Q5 [16m] Medieval Ideas on Cause of Illness: Religion vs Nature c1250-c1500
Q6: Judgement Essay (Choice B) 16m + 4m SPaG (Extended)	Q6 [16m] Advances in Surgery: 18th/19th Century vs 20th Century	Q6 [16m] Role of Government in Medicine c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Infectious Diseases c1500-c1900	Q6 [16m] Pasteur & Causes of Illness c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Attitudes Towards Medicine c1700-c1900	Q6 [16m] Role of Individuals in Prevention c1700-present	Q6 [16m] Role of Government in Hospital Care c1800-present	Q6 [16m] Science & Technology as Main Reason for Modern Progress c1900-present

Figure 4: Pearson Edexcel Past Exam Question Matrix (8-Series Analysis, 2018–2026). Departmental tracking across Medicine, Elizabethan, Middle East, Germany, and USA. Flags unexamined syllabus themes, allowing teachers to deliver high-yield classroom rehearsals and automated 20-question mastery quizzes.